

Data-Driven Insights in shaping Market-Entry Decisions and Entrepreneurial Strategies

Updated project plan submitted to AF Lindstedt in Aug 2025

Duration of Proposed Research:	21 st August 2025 to 31 st Dec 2026 (17 months)
Hosting Organization:	Arcada University of Applied Sciences
Topic of Research:	Data-Driven Insights for Strategic Decision-making
Funds	€ 69784

Summary of Changes in this document

There was an organizational restructuring at Arcada UAS in May 2025. That severely impacted the resources (personnel) available to work with us on the planned research project. We have now adapted ourselves to the changed scenario and updated the project plan. This document explains the changes to the project plan.

- Start date moves to 21st August 2025. That is because we needed time to select the right persons to work with. More important, we needed to arrange the work contracts for the new persons to contribute to our project. That has been settled now.
- The content of the project, the aims, the methodologies and the procedures do NOT change. We continue exactly with our previous aims as written in our original proposal and plans.
- End date does not change. We plan (and need) to finish in time. The deadlines are internally tightened to ensure that the end date is unaffected.

1. UPDATED Project Timeline

We propose an 17-month project with the detailed timelines as illustrated in **Figure 1**.

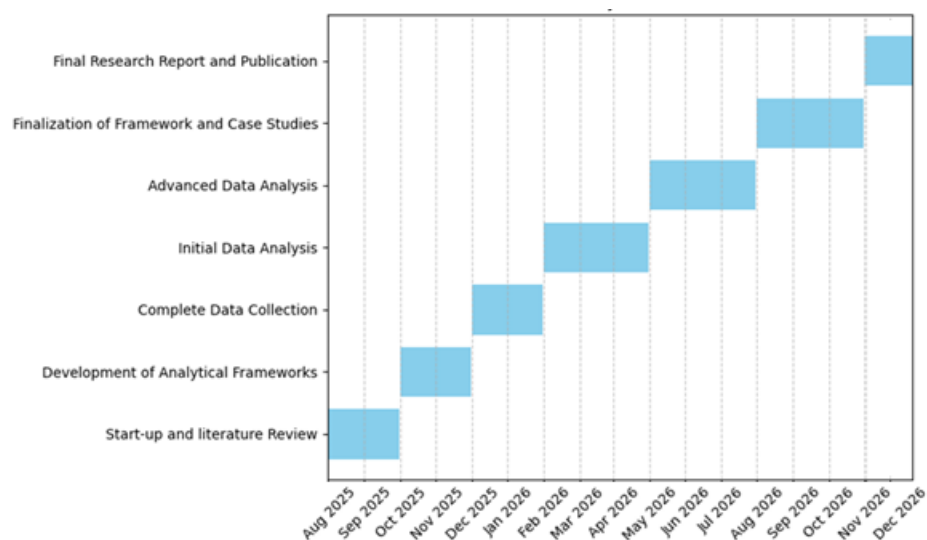


Figure 1: Updated Project timelines across all phases

The detailed plan for Year 1 is as follows:

- **Months 1-2:** A comprehensive and in-depth literature review will be undertaken, specifically addressing each of the seven research questions outlined in the proposal. This phase will focus on synthesizing existing knowledge, identifying key theoretical frameworks, and pinpointing significant gaps in the understanding of the research topic.
- **Months 3-4:** The research team will focus on the development of detailed analytical frameworks and specific methodologies for addressing each of the research questions. This will include the careful selection of appropriate data analysis techniques, the establishment of clear criteria for the selection of relevant case study companies, and the design of interview protocols for the primary data collection phase.
- **Months 5-6:** This phase will be dedicated to the collection of data. The primary focus will be on in-depth primary data collection. This will involve conducting the planned semi-structured interviews with representatives from the selected case study companies and with the identified industry experts. Extensive secondary data analysis will be conducted, and the process of identifying, recruiting, and establishing initial contact with potential case study companies and relevant industry experts will be initiated.
- **Months 7-9:** Initial analysis of the collected data will commence. This will include conducting preliminary quantitative analyses of secondary datasets and beginning the initial write-up of case studies based on publicly available secondary sources.
- **Months 10-12:** The research team will engage in advanced data analysis. This will include the development and rigorous validation of machine learning models specifically designed for market trend forecasting and new product/service viability assessment. Furthermore, in-depth qualitative analysis of the interview transcripts and the comprehensive case study data will be conducted to extract key insights and findings.

The detailed plan for the 6 months of Year 2 is as follows:

- **Months 1-3:** Based on the research findings, the team will focus on the development of a practical and comprehensive educational framework specifically designed for business schools to effectively educate PhD students on the application of data-driven insights within the fields of entrepreneurship and market analysis.
- **Months 4-6:** The final phase of the project will be dedicated to the writing of the comprehensive research report, the dissemination of the key research findings through academic publications and conference presentations, and the finalization of all project outcomes, including the detailed case study compendium and the finalized educational framework for business schools.

2. Funding and Resourcing

We had requested a total fund of €69784 to execute this research. The funding TOTAL amount remains unchanged.

Table 1: Effort (person hours) expected from participants (No Changes)

Person/Resource Name	Efforts in Person Hours
Dr Niraj Ramesh (Principal Researcher)	180
Dr Mark Dougherty (Dean for Research)	20
Commercialization expert (Faculty member with business skills)	65
Master's Student (MBA)	550
PhD Student (Business Analytics and Finance)	375
Industry/Business leaders, External SMEs and consultants	100

Next, we provide the commercial details of the overall expenses expected for the overall research project in **Table 2** below. Around 80% expenses arise from the (direct or indirect) salaries of the researchers working on this proposed research project. We include costs for business travels because we expect to collaborate with academic and industrial organizations across the Nordics.

Table 2: Expense headings in overall budget (No Changes)

Expense Heading	Amount €
Direct wages of researchers	41690
Administrative costs and indirect wages	13956
External SME expenses	4388
Travel, conferences and publications	6000
Material purchases	3750
Total Funding Requested	69784

3. Roles and Responsibilities of Team members

We have shortlisted the key personnel who we require to work on the research proposal. The following persons have been approached:

Table 3: Personnel for Research Positions

Role	Person(s) and Details
Principal Investigator	Principal Investigator remains unchanged: Dr Niraj Dayama. He has been assigned additional work-time in Arcada by reducing and reassigning many of his academic responsibilities so that he can focus specifically on research in TUF/Lindstedt projects.
Commercialization Expert #1	Faculty members with proven business research skills: 1. First choice: Jaakko Vuolasto → CV is attached. We are arranging the inter-organizational arrangements to confirm his time and efforts for our project. 2. Second choice: Lahtinen Anna → We have done initial discussions and the discussions were positive. We will consider to onboard only if our first choice does not materialize.
Commercialization Expert #2	External SME First choice: Gandharv Arora → CV was already provided.
Industry/Business leaders	Industry/Business leaders in active discussion with us are: 1. Eira Seppala (Fortum) 2. Paresh Mandpe (ABB)
PhD Student	Bakajic Misa → https://www.linkedin.com/in/misabakajic/
MBA Student	Multiple students from Arcada Business school

We also note that some of the listed personnel may join us contractually or as inter-organization arrangements instead of being direct employees at Arcada UAS. Prof Mark Dougherty (Dean for the Graduate School and Research at Arcada UAS) will mentor the project. Existing academic collaboration with Finnish and Nordic universities will be leveraged wherever relevant to ensure suitable skillsets for the success of this project. No separate costs are required within this project for such collaborations.

4. Conclusion

We faced challenges due to the re-organization at Arcada UAS. We have worked around those challenges and are now ready to start almost as planned. We expect to conclude on plan.